

(DAY - 04)

Spendly: Product Requirements Document

Mobile expense tracking app (iOS and Android), with a BRD vs PRD comparison note at the end.

Field	Detail
Product	Spendly, a mobile expense tracking app (iOS and Android)
Version	1.0 (MVP)
Owner	Product Manager
Status	Draft for review

Product Overview

Spendly helps individuals record, categorize and understand their spending in under 10 seconds per entry. Most people abandon expense tracking because logging is tedious and the insight comes too late. Spendly fixes both: fast capture (manual entry, receipt scan) and immediate feedback (budgets, monthly summaries, alerts).

Problem statement: People who want to control their spending don't track it consistently, because existing tools are slow to use and show insights only after the money is gone.

Target platforms: iOS 16+ and Android 10+.

Goals and Objectives

Goal	Objective (measurable)
Make logging effortless	Median time to log an expense $\leq$ 10 seconds
Build a tracking habit	40% of activated users log $\geq$ 3 expenses per week at Week 4
Deliver useful insight	60% of users set at least one budget within 7 days of signup
Earn trust	Crash-free sessions $\geq$ 99.5%; zero data-loss incidents

User Personas

Persona 1: Maya, 29, freelance designer

Irregular income, mixes business and personal spending. **Needs:** tag expenses as business vs personal, attach receipts, export for tax time. **Frustration:** loses receipts, reconstructs expenses at year end.

Persona 2: Omar, 20, university student

Fixed monthly allowance, small frequent purchases, price-sensitive. **Needs:** fast logging, a simple "how much do I have left this month" view, alerts before overspending. **Frustration:** money is gone by week three and he doesn't know where it went.

Persona 3: Sara, 38, parent managing household budget

Shares finances with her spouse, handles bills, groceries and school costs. **Needs:** shared household view, recurring bill tracking, category budgets. **Frustration:** two people logging in different places, duplicate or missing entries.

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

Format: *As a [user], I want to [action] so that [benefit]*. Acceptance criteria use **Given / When / Then**.

US-01: Quick manual entry (Omar)

As a student, I want to log an expense with amount, category and date in a few taps so that I record purchases while they're fresh.

- **Given** I'm on the home screen, **when** I tap "+" and enter an amount and choose a category, **then** the expense is saved with today's date by default and appears at the top of my list.
- **Given** I enter an amount of 0 or leave it empty, **when** I tap Save, **then** the app blocks saving and shows "Enter an amount greater than 0."

US-02: Receipt scanning (Maya)

As a freelancer, I want to photograph a receipt so that the amount, merchant and date are filled in automatically.

- **Given** I'm on the add-expense screen, **when** I scan a legible receipt, **then** amount, merchant and date are pre-filled within 5 seconds and I can edit them before saving.
- **Given** the scan cannot read the receipt, **when** processing finishes, **then** the photo is kept as an attachment and I'm prompted to enter details manually.

US-03: Custom categories (Sara)

As a parent, I want to create and edit my own categories so that my reports match how my household actually spends.

- **Given** I'm in Settings > Categories, **when** I create "School Fees" with an icon and color, **then** it's available immediately when adding expenses.
- **Given** I delete a category that has expenses, **when** I confirm, **then** I'm asked to reassign those expenses to another category before deletion completes.

US-04: Monthly budget by category (Omar)

As a student, I want to set a monthly budget per category so that I know how much I can still spend.

- **Given** I set a Food budget of 400, **when** I add expenses totaling 150 in that

category, **then** the budget screen shows 150 spent, 250 remaining and a progress bar at 37%.

- **Given** a new month begins, **when** I open the app, **then** budgets reset and last month's figures are saved in history.

US-05: Budget alerts (Omar)

As a student, I want a notification when I'm close to my budget so that I can stop before overspending.

- **Given** I have push notifications enabled, **when** spending in a category reaches 80% of its budget, **then** I receive one notification naming the category and the remaining amount.
- **Given** spending reaches 100%, **when** the expense is saved, **then** a second "budget exceeded" notification is sent, and no further alerts are sent for that category that month.

US-06: Spending summary and charts (Sara)

As a household manager, I want a monthly breakdown by category so that I can see where most of the money goes.

- **Given** I have at least one expense this month, **when** I open Insights, **then** I see a category breakdown chart and total spent, matching the sum of the expense list exactly.
- **Given** I switch the period to a previous month, **when** the screen reloads, **then** the chart and totals update within 1 second.

US-07: Recurring expenses (Sara)

As a parent, I want to mark bills as recurring so that rent and subscriptions are logged automatically.

- **Given** I create an expense with "Repeat monthly" on the 1st, **when** the 1st arrives, **then** a new expense is created automatically and I'm notified.
- **Given** I edit a recurring expense, **when** I save, **then** I can choose "this one only" or "this and future," and only the chosen entries change.

US-08: Shared household account (Sara)

As a parent, I want to invite my spouse to a shared account so that we both log into one set of expenses.

- **Given** I send an invite by email or link, **when** my spouse accepts, **then** both of us see the same expenses and budgets, each entry showing who logged it.
- **Given** a member is removed, **when** the owner confirms, **then** that member loses access immediately and their past entries remain in the shared history.

US-09: Business/personal tagging and export (Maya)

As a freelancer, I want to tag expenses as business or personal and export them so that I can prepare my taxes.

- **Given** I've tagged expenses over a date range, **when** I choose Export > CSV with the "Business" filter, **then** I receive a file containing only business expenses with date, merchant, category, amount and receipt link.

- **Given** an export contains more than 5,000 rows, **when** I request it, **then** it completes in under 30 seconds or runs in the background and notifies me when ready.

US-10: Secure sign-in and sync (all personas)

As a user, I want my data protected and available across devices so that I don't lose it if I change phones.

- **Given** I've enabled biometric lock, **when** I open the app after it was backgrounded for more than 1 minute, **then** I must authenticate before seeing any data.
- **Given** I sign in on a new device, **when** authentication succeeds, **then** all my expenses, budgets and categories appear within 10 seconds.

US-11: Offline logging, bonus (Omar)

As a student, I want to log expenses without internet so that I never skip an entry.

- **Given** the device is offline, **when** I add an expense, **then** it saves locally and syncs automatically on reconnect, with no duplicates.

Features List

ID	Feature	Priority	Stories
F1	Manual expense entry (add/edit/delete)	P0	US-01
F2	Default + custom categories	P0	US-03
F3	Monthly budgets per category	P0	US-04
F4	Account creation, sign-in, cloud sync	P0	US-10
F5	Spending summary and charts	P0	US-06
F6	Offline mode with sync	P0	US-11
F7	Budget alerts (push)	P1	US-05
F8	Receipt scan (OCR)	P1	US-02
F9	Recurring expenses	P1	US-07
F10	CSV export + business/personal tags	P1	US-09
F11	Biometric app lock	P1	US-10
F12	Shared household accounts	P2	US-08
F13	Multi-currency with exchange rates	P2	n/a

ID	Feature	Priority	Stories
F14	Dark mode, widgets, home-screen quick add	P2	n/a

P0 = launch blocker. **P1** = needed for a competitive v1, ship if capacity allows. **P2** = post-launch.

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
FR-1	The system shall let users create an expense with amount (required), category (required), date (default today), note, and optional photo.
FR-2	The system shall provide at least 10 default categories and allow unlimited custom categories.
FR-3	The system shall calculate spent, remaining and percentage for each budget in real time.
FR-4	The system shall generate a push notification when spending crosses 80% and 100% of a budget (once per threshold per month).
FR-5	The system shall extract amount, merchant and date from receipt images via OCR.
FR-6	The system shall create recurring expenses automatically on schedule (weekly, monthly, yearly).
FR-7	The system shall export filtered expenses as CSV.
FR-8	The system shall queue offline changes and sync them on reconnect with conflict resolution (latest edit wins, with the edit history kept).
FR-9	The system shall support email and Apple/Google sign-in, and permanent account deletion on request.

Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement
Performance	Cold start ≤ 2 s on mid-range devices; list scrolling at 60 fps with 10,000 expenses; chart load ≤ 1 s
Reliability	Crash-free sessions $\geq 99.5\%$; backend uptime $\geq 99.9\%$; no data loss on sync failure
Security	Data encrypted in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest (AES-256); biometric lock option; no storage of bank credentials
Privacy	Compliance with applicable data-protection laws (e.g. GDPR); explicit consent for notifications and camera; user can export and

Area	Requirement
	delete all data
Usability	Add-expense flow ≤ 3 taps to save; WCAG 2.1 AA contrast; supports dynamic font sizes
Compatibility	iOS 16+, Android 10+, phones and tablets in portrait; English and Arabic (RTL) at launch
Scalability	Supports 100,000 active users at launch without architecture changes

Out of Scope (v1.0)

- Direct bank account linking or automatic transaction import
- Investment, loan or net-worth tracking
- Bill payment or any money movement
- Invoicing and full business accounting
- Web or desktop app
- AI-based financial advice

Success Metrics

Metric	Definition	Target (90 days post-launch)
Activation rate	Users who log ≥ 3 expenses in first 7 days	$\geq 50\%$
Week-4 retention	Users active in Week 4 / users who signed up	$\geq 30\%$
Weekly active loggers	Users logging ≥ 3 expenses/week	$\geq 40\%$ of activated users
Time to log	Median seconds from tapping "+" to saving	≤ 10 s
Budget adoption	Users with ≥ 1 budget within 7 days	$\geq 60\%$
Receipt scan accuracy	Scans needing no manual correction	$\geq 80\%$
App store rating	Average rating	≥ 4.4
Stability	Crash-free sessions	$\geq 99.5\%$

Guardrail: notification opt-out rate must stay below 25%, otherwise alert frequency is reviewed.

Timeline

Phase	Duration	Deliverables
Discovery and design	Weeks 1–3	User interviews, wireframes, design system, technical spike for OCR
Build: P0	Weeks 4–9	F1–F6 working end-to-end; internal alpha
Build: P1	Weeks 10–13	F7–F11; closed beta (200 users)
Hardening and QA	Weeks 14–15	Performance, security review, accessibility audit, bug fixes
Launch	Week 16	Staged rollout (10% → 50% → 100%), app store release
Post-launch (P2)	Weeks 17+	Shared accounts, multi-currency, widgets, based on metrics

Risks and Open Questions

- **OCR accuracy** on Arabic and handwritten receipts: may need a third-party service (cost vs accuracy).
- **Notification fatigue** could drive uninstalls; alert frequency needs beta testing.
- **Shared accounts (P2)** may be more important than expected for Sara-type users; revisit after beta feedback.
- **Open**: free vs freemium model, and which features sit behind a paywall.

Comparison Note: BRD vs PRD

A **BRD (Business Requirements Document)** explains *why* the business should do something. A **PRD (Product Requirements Document)** explains *what* the product must do to deliver that value.

Aspect	BRD	PRD
Core question	Why are we doing this, and what business outcome do we need?	What exactly are we building, and for whom?
Audience	Executives, sponsors, finance, stakeholders	Engineers, designers, QA, marketing
Contents	Business case, objectives, ROI, scope, stakeholders, constraints, risks	Personas, user stories, features, functional and non-functional requirements, acceptance criteria, metrics
Level of detail	High-level, business language	Detailed, testable, product language
Owner	Business Analyst or business sponsor / project manager	Product Manager

Aspect	BRD	PRD
Approved by	Executive sponsor, finance, business stakeholders	Engineering lead, design lead, product leadership
Written	First, to get a go/no-go decision and funding	After approval, to guide the build

When to use which

- Use a **BRD** when a project needs business justification, budget approval or cross-department alignment: large initiatives, new product lines, vendor or regulatory-driven projects. Typical in traditional or enterprise settings.
- Use a **PRD** when the build team needs to know what to make. Every product team needs one, and in agile or startup settings it is often the *only* document, with the business case folded into a short overview.
- In larger organizations, use **both in sequence**: the BRD gets the project approved, and the PRD translates it into buildable requirements. Each PRD goal should trace back to a BRD objective.

Example (Spendly): The BRD would say, "Capture the personal-finance segment; target 100,000 users and \$X revenue in year one, with an estimated cost of \$Y." The PRD is the first part of this document: who the users are, what features exist, and when a feature counts as done.